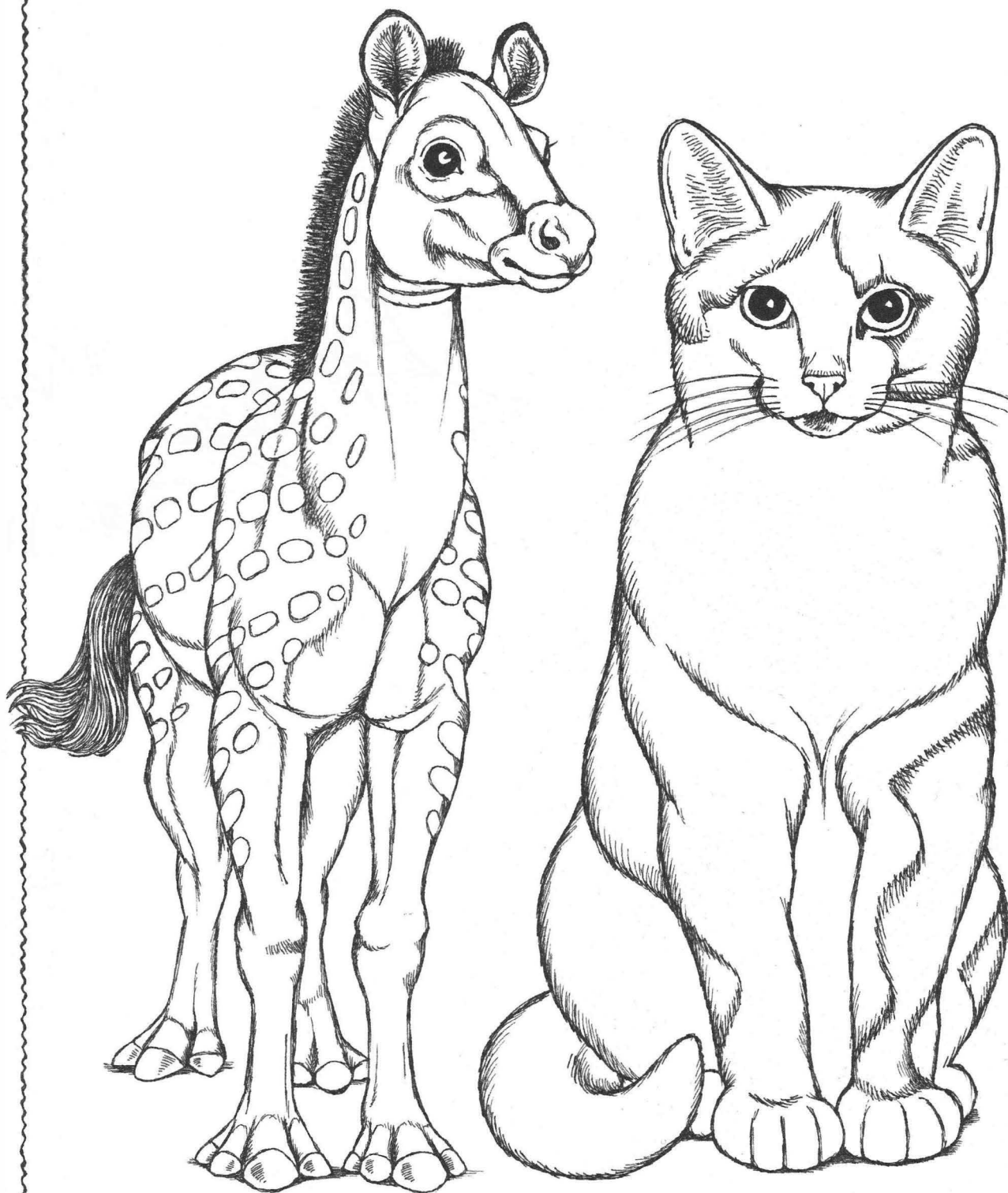




The very first horse browsed along the Eocene forest floor 55 million years ago. This little animal *Hyracotherium*, no bigger than a large cat, was a distant relative of all the horses that followed. The four toes on each front foot and three on each

back one were probably padded in order to make walking on the moist ground easier. The pads worked because early horses were travelers, migrating from North America to Siberia, Asia, and Europe when sea levels were lower.